

Paper 2: Investigation and Breadth Studies

Content overview

Students must study **one** historical investigation from the following:

A1 The origins and course of the First World War, 1905–18

A2 Russia and the Soviet Union, 1905–24

A3 The USA, 1918–41

A4 The Vietnam Conflict, 1945–75

A5 East Germany, 1958–90.

Students must **study** one breadth study in change from the following:

B1 America: from new nation to divided union, 1783–1877

B2 Changes in medicine, c1848–c1948

B3 Japan in transformation, 1853–1945

B4 China: conflict, crisis and change, 1900–89

B5 The changing role of international organisations: the league and the UN, 1919–c2011

B6 The changing nature of warfare and international conflict, 1919–2011

B7 The Middle East: conflict, crisis and change, 1917–2012

B8 Diversity, rights and equality in Britain, 1914–2010.

Assessment overview

Students are assessed through an examination based on their **historical investigation** and **breadth study in change**.

- Students answer **two** questions, **one** question on their historical investigation and **one** question on their breadth study in change.

A1 The origins and course of the First World War, 1905–18

What students need to study:

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| 1 | The alliance system and international rivalry, 1905–14 | The system of alliances and ententes before 1914, including the Triple Alliance and the formation of the Triple Entente. Economic, imperial and military causes of international rivalry. |
| 2 | The growth of tension in Europe, 1905–14 | <p>The key issues in the Balkans and their significance for international relations, including Balkan nationalism and Austro-Serbian rivalry. The features and impact of the Bosnian Crisis (1908–09) and the Balkan Wars (1912–13).</p> <p>The features and significance of Anglo-German rivalry, including the naval race and the Moroccan Crises of 1905–06 and 1911. The assassination at Sarajevo and its consequences. The events leading to the outbreak of war, including the part played by international agreements and the roles of the great powers.</p> |
| 3 | The Schlieffen Plan and deadlock on the Western Front | The Schlieffen Plan and reasons for its failure. The trench system, life in the trenches, new weapons and methods. Reasons for deadlock. Key features of Somme and Passchendaele. Successes and failures on the Western Front, including the responsibility of Haig. |
| 4 | The war at sea and Gallipoli | German threat to Britain in North Sea. German raids, Heligoland Bight, Dogger Bank and Jutland. The U-boat threat, the Lusitania and anti-U-boat measures. Reasons for, and key features of, the Gallipoli campaign. Evacuation and effects of campaign. |
| 5 | The defeat of Germany | The significance of the US entry into the war. Key features of the Ludendorff spring offensive (1918). The Allied drive to victory (July–November 1918) and reasons for German defeat. |
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